



PROJECT TITLE: Miss Juneteenth Blues

LOGLINE

When a down-on-her-luck former Miss Juneteenth, desperate to save her struggling salon and secure her daughter's future, fakes her age to re-enter the prestigious pageant, she uncovers a rigged system built on lies and legacy, igniting a fierce movement that redefines what it means to wear a crown in a world obsessed with perfection.

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Little Miss Sunshine meets **Eve's Bayou** – a heartfelt, genuinely funny, and deeply poignant dramedy infused with the rich, soulful essence of the American South. We blend laugh-out-loud

humor with moments of raw vulnerability, underscored by gospel montages that stir the spirit, glitter under pressure, and the undeniable resilience of Black women who don't just wear their scars like crowns, but turn them into battle armor. Expect vibrant aesthetics, sharp dialogue, and a touch of Southern gothic charm.

THEMES

- **Legacy vs. Liberation:** The struggle between honoring tradition and breaking free to forge one's own path.
 - **Authenticity as Power:** The radical act of embracing one's true, unapologetic self as the ultimate form of beauty and strength.
 - **Mother-Daughter Healing:** A complex, evolving relationship where love transcends control, fostering mutual understanding and championship.
 - **Redemption Through Community:** How one woman's personal fight can ignite a powerful, transformative movement for an entire community.
 - **The Unbreakable Spirit of Black Womanhood:** A vibrant celebration of resilience, humor, and the profound strength found in sisterhood and self-discovery.
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PITCH

MISS JUNETEENTH BLUES is a vibrant, empowering dramedy that cracks open the glittering world of a beloved Southern pageant to reveal a story of intergenerational dreams, fierce female solidarity, and the profound power of authentic self-worth. At its heart, it's a universal tale about a mother's fight for her daughter's future that unexpectedly becomes a fight for her own redemption and a movement for an entire community. With its blend of sharp humor, emotional depth, and culturally rich backdrop, this project promises high stakes, unforgettable characters, and a message that resonates deeply with today's audiences yearning for stories of triumph, sisterhood, and real-world impact. It's a broadcast and streaming sensation in the making, perfectly positioned to capture hearts and spark conversations.

DETAILED SYNOPSIS

Toni Dupree, once the radiant Miss Juneteenth 1999, now finds her life a far cry from the promised glory. Her dreams deferred, she runs a struggling nail salon, Toni's Touch, clinging to her past

prestige by wearing her crown to church every Sunday. But when her landlord threatens eviction, Toni faces financial ruin. Hope flickers when her fiercely independent, spoken-word poet daughter, **Amara**, earns a spot in the prestigious Miss Juneteenth Pageant – until Toni discovers the crucial \$20,000 scholarship has been reduced, with the full amount dependent on winning a rigged "Legacy of Excellence" bonus, controlled by her cutthroat former rival, **Corinne Whitmore**, the pageant director.

Desperate, Toni makes a reckless decision: she fakes her ID, lies about her age, and enters the pageant herself, hoping to win the bonus for Amara. Her deception lands her in training camp, where she's decades older than the other contestants. Amidst the whispered judgments, she finds unexpected kinship with the **Sisterhood of Second Chances**: Shirley Mae, escaping a romance scam; Renee, an investigative journalist undercover; and Candy, rebuilding her life after betrayal. They bond over shared vulnerabilities and unspoken dreams, realizing the pageant means more than just a crown.

The arrival of Toni's charismatic ex-husband, **Darnell**, as the talent coach ignites old flames and unresolved tensions, adding a layer of romantic drama to the high-pressure environment. As the pageant nears, Corinne ratchets up the stakes, announcing the swimsuit round will be televised live, pushing Toni to the brink. In a climactic fight, Amara confronts Toni about her deception, accusing her mother of still chasing a crown that never saved her. Heartbroken and stranded after a car breakdown, Toni finds a moment of spiritual clarity, realizing she's now fighting for herself, too.

The pageant's grand finale is a spectacle of glamour and tension. Amara delivers a searing, authentic spoken-word performance that electrifies the audience. Toni, embodying quiet dignity, faces Corinne's pointed interview questions with defiant grace. But it's the swimsuit round that becomes iconic: a stage fan accidentally blows off Toni's wig, revealing her natural, silver-streaked hair. The gasps turn to thunderous applause, with Amara proudly shouting, "That's my mama! That's real beauty!" as #CrownsOverPerfection trends nationwide.

In the ensuing viral chaos, Renee exposes Corinne's decades of corruption, leading to her dramatic ousting. Amara wins the Legacy Bonus, delivering a powerful speech that credits Toni and redefines what it means to be a queen. The pageant transforms into the **Miss Juneteenth Leadership Academy**, with Toni as Head Mentor. Amara creates a documentary, Darnell opens a music school, and the Sisterhood launches a popular podcast. The film closes with Toni, truly liberated, placing her symbolic crown on a pedestal "For the Next Queen," walking hand-in-hand with Amara into a future defined by authenticity and collective empowerment.

OUTLINE

ACT I: THE CROWN CALLS

- **Opening:** Toni, former Miss Juneteenth '99, performs her Sunday ritual, wearing her crown to church, but her eyes reveal weariness. Her salon, Toni's Touch, is struggling, facing eviction.
- **Inciting Incident:** Amara gets into the Miss Juneteenth Pageant, but the scholarship is mostly contingent on winning the "Legacy Bonus" controlled by Toni's rival, Corinne. Toni learns the pageant is rigged. Inspired by her past and desperate for Amara's future, Toni makes the impulsive decision to forge her age and enter the pageant herself. She's accepted as "Toni D. Price."

ACT II: SEQUINS & SECRETS

- **Rising Action:**
 - Toni navigates training camp, an outsider due to her age, but finds camaraderie with the "Sisterhood of Second Chances" (Shirley Mae, Renee, Candy), each with their own secret motivations.
 - **Twist #1:** Toni's charming ex-husband, Darnell, returns as the talent coach, rekindling their complex chemistry and unresolved feelings. He coaches both Amara and Toni.
 - **Twist #2:** Corinne announces the swimsuit round will be televised live, pushing Toni into a panic and exposing her insecurities.
- **Midpoint Crisis:** Toni nearly quits, confessing her deception to an enraged Amara. They have a devastating fight. Toni, at rock bottom, finds a renewed sense of purpose: she's now doing this for herself, too.

ACT III: THE PAGEANT & THE RECKONING

- **Climax:**
 - The Grand Finale: Evening Gown, Amara's powerful spoken-word talent, Toni's defiant interview with Corinne.
 - The Wig Flies Off: During the televised swimsuit round, Toni's wig comes off. Initial shock turns into a viral moment of applause and Amara's proud declaration, making #CrownsOverPerfection trend.
 - The Exposure: Renee, the journalist, exposes Corinne's corruption with audio evidence, leading to Corinne's downfall.
- **Falling Action:**
 - Amara wins the Legacy Bonus, delivering a powerful, heartfelt speech that honors Toni and redefines the meaning of a queen.
 - The pageant is rebranded as the Miss Juneteenth Leadership Academy.
- **Resolution:** Toni becomes Head Mentor, Amara films a documentary, Darnell rekindles with Toni and opens a music school, and the Sisterhood launches a podcast. Toni takes off her crown-pin, symbolizing her liberation, walking off with Amara into a hopeful future.

CHARACTER BREAKDOWN

- **LaTonya “Toni” Dupree (49):** Our captivating lead. A former beauty queen whose life didn't unfold as planned, she carries the weight of deferred dreams but masks it with humor and fierce determination. Her arc is about reclaiming her identity, confronting past wounds (especially from Corinne), and learning that true value isn't found in a crown, but in authenticity and empowering others. She starts desperate and deceptive, but ends as a leader and a beacon of real beauty.
- **Corinne Whitmore (50):** The formidable antagonist. Polished, powerful, and utterly ruthless, Corinne embodies the toxic side of tradition and legacy. Her motivation stems from a desire to maintain control and a perceived sense of "excellence" (often tied to wealth), and perhaps a lingering bitterness from her own past loss to Toni. Her downfall is not just external but reveals the hollowness beneath her perfect facade.
- **Amara Dupree (16):** Toni's sharp, artistic daughter. She's bright, talented (a spoken-word poet), and cynical about institutions like pageants. Her arc involves moving past resentment for her mother's "chasing" of dreams to understanding Toni's sacrifices, and ultimately finding her own powerful voice that transcends superficiality. She learns that true change comes from within and requires standing up for what's right.
- **Darnell “D” Dupree (52):** Toni's charming ex-husband. A smooth jazz singer, he represents Toni's past love and the dreams they once shared. His return as talent coach creates compelling romantic tension and offers Toni a chance at renewed connection. His arc is about mature reconciliation and finding his own purpose, mirroring Toni's journey.
- **Shirley Mae (55):** A sweet, empathetic retired teacher, seeking to rebuild her self-worth after a financial scam. She's the heart of the Sisterhood, reminding them of the joy and simple dignity in being seen.
- **Renee (51):** The sharp, observant journalist undercover. Her mission to expose corruption drives a key plotline, but her vulnerability among the Sisterhood reveals her personal stake in seeking justice.
- **Candy (48):** The sassy, resilient hair salon owner. Her humor and no-nonsense attitude provide levity, but her deeper motivation is to prove her strength after a humiliating divorce, embodying the "second chance" theme.

TALENT SUGGESTIONS

We envision a dynamic, talented ensemble, anchored by a strong, relatable lead.

- **LaTonya “Toni” Dupree:**
 - **Regina Hall** (Exceptional range, comedic timing, dramatic depth, and broad appeal.)
 - **Nia Long** (Warmth, intelligence, relatable vulnerability, established audience favorite.)
 - **Gabrielle Union** (Charismatic, strong dramatic actress, known for empowering roles.)
 - **Corinne Whitmore:**
 - **Nicole Ari Parker** (Sophisticated, formidable screen presence, can play nuanced villainy.)
 - **Lynn Whitfield** (Iconic, commanding, brings a powerful gravitas and elegance.)
 - **Tisha Campbell** (Known for comedic roles but has shown great dramatic capability, offering a fresh take.)
 - **Amara Dupree:**
 - **Storm Reid** (Rising star, conveys intelligence and emotional depth, strong screen presence.)
 - **Lyric Ross** (Authentic, compelling, demonstrated strong dramatic abilities.)
 - **Marsai Martin** (Talented young actress with great comedic and dramatic potential.)
 - **Darnell “D” Dupree:**
 - **Blair Underwood** (Smooth, charming, seasoned actor with excellent chemistry.)
 - **Laz Alonso** (Charismatic, strong dramatic lead, known for romantic roles.)
 - **Mekhi Phifer** (Versatile, brings depth and an appealing maturity.)
 - **The Sisterhood of Second Chances:**
 - **Shirley Mae:** Jenifer Lewis (Legendary comedic timing, undeniable presence), Loretta Devine (Warmth, humor, established appeal).
 - **Renee:** Aunjanue Ellis (Powerful dramatic actress, intelligent and nuanced), Emayatzy Corinealdi (Strong, grounded performer).
 - **Candy:** Tiffany Haddish (Infectious humor, strong personality, relatable), Kym Whitley (Veteran comedic actress, delivers heart and laughs).
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MISS JUNETEENTH BLUES



REGINA HALL
LATONYA "TONI" DUPREE



NICOLE ARI PARKER
CORINNE WHITMORE



STORM REID
AMARA DUPREE



BLAIR UNDERWOOD
DARNELL "D" DUPREE

**JENIFER
LEWIS**
SHIRLEY MAE



DIRECTOR MATCH SUGGESTIONS

We seek directors who excel at character-driven narratives, particularly those with strong female leads, vibrant cultural settings, and a knack for balancing humor and pathos.

- **Ava DuVernay:** (Known for **Queen Sugar**, **Selma**) – Masterful at depicting complex family dynamics, Southern culture, and empowering Black women's narratives with cinematic grace.
- **Tina Gordon:** (Known for **Little**; writer for **Peeples**) – Offers a proven ability to weave sharp comedy with heartfelt emotional beats, creating memorable, relatable characters.
- **Stella Meghie:** (Known for **The Photograph**, **The Weekend**) – Brings a sophisticated visual style and a nuanced approach to romantic and family dramas, with a keen eye for character authenticity.
- **Patrik-Ian Polk:** (Known for **P-Valley**, **Noah's Arc**) – Experienced in Southern-set dramas with rich character development and a bold, authentic voice.

LOOKBOOK OR MOOD REEL REFERENCES

- **Film References:**
 - **Little Miss Sunshine:** For its quirky humor, ensemble heart, and journey of self-acceptance.
 - **Eve's Bayou:** For its rich Southern atmosphere, touch of magical realism, and focus on family secrets and strong female perspectives.
 - **Miss Juneteenth (2020 film):** For its authentic portrayal of a similar pageant world and themes of generational aspirations and deferred dreams.
 - **Joyful Noise:** For its celebration of Black church culture, gospel music, and community spirit.
- **Series References:**
 - **Queen Sugar:** For its deep dive into Southern family dynamics, visual storytelling, and empowering themes for Black women.
 - **P-Valley:** For its vibrant, gritty, and authentic portrayal of specific Southern cultural milieus and complex female characters.

MARKETING HOOKS & PROMO-READY TAGLINES

- **Marketing Hooks:**
 - "A fierce mother-daughter showdown that becomes a revolution."
 - "She lied for a crown. She fought for a movement."
 - "The pageant rules are about to be rewritten – by the women who know them best."
 - "Get ready for glitter, gospel, and a game-changing wig moment."
 - "More than a crown. More than a pageant. It's a powerful fight for what's real."
 - **Promo-Ready Taglines:**
 - **She wore the crown once. This time, she'll break it open.**
 - **The Queen has returned. And she's brought a movement.**
 - **Beauty is more than skin deep. It's soul deep.**
 - **The crown was hers. The fight was theirs.**
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TARGET AUDIENCE & MARKET

MISS JUNETEENTH BLUES is strategically positioned to appeal to a broad, yet clearly defined, audience segment that networks and streamers are actively pursuing.

- **Core Audience (Primary):**
 - **Women 25-54, with a strong emphasis on Black women 30-65+ years old.** This demographic is highly engaged with stories of empowerment, family dynamics, romantic drama, and cultural celebration. They value authentic representation and narratives that reflect their experiences and aspirations.
 - Viewers who tune into channels like **Lifetime, OWN, BET**, and streamers like **Netflix, Apple TV+, Amazon Prime Video** known for character-driven dramas and compelling female-led stories.
 - **Secondary Audience:**
 - Younger audiences (18-24) drawn to Amara's coming-of-age story, spoken-word artistry, and themes of challenging systemic corruption and finding authentic self-expression.
 - Families who appreciate uplifting, inspirational stories with positive messages about community and overcoming adversity.
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WHY IT SELLS

- **Empowerment & Relatability:** A universal story of a mother's love, second chances, and finding strength in authenticity, resonating deeply with audiences seeking inspiration and relatable struggles.

- **Cultural Authenticity:** Richly steeped in Black Southern culture, Juneteenth celebrations, gospel music, and community traditions, offering unique texture and appeal while remaining universally accessible.
 - **High Stakes & Conflict:** Financial desperation, intergenerational conflict, romantic tension, and a corrupt system create compelling, propulsive drama.
 - **Humor & Heart:** A perfectly balanced tone that promises both genuine laughter and heartfelt tears, a proven formula for audience engagement.
 - **Timely & Relevant:** Addresses contemporary themes of challenging outdated beauty standards, systemic injustice, and celebrating Black womanhood, making it highly relevant to current social conversations.
 - **Viral Potential:** The "wig flying off" moment and the #CrownsOverPerfection hashtag are tailor-made for social media buzz and shareability, driving viewership.
 - **Strong Characters & Ensemble:** A vibrant cast of characters, particularly the "Sisterhood of Second Chances," offers multiple entry points for audience connection.
 - **Proven Track Record:** Aligns perfectly with the programming strategies of networks and streamers seeking compelling, diverse, female-centric narratives.
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COMPARABLE FILMS & SERIES

This project combines the best elements of successful titles that resonate with our target demographics:

- **Films:**
 - **Miss Juneteenth (2020):** Shared thematic core of a former queen re-entering the pageant world and the intergenerational pressure. *Miss Juneteenth Blues* elevates this with higher stakes, more overt humor, and a broader ensemble.
 - **Little Miss Sunshine:** For its quirky, heartfelt dramedy, ensemble road-trip feel, and themes of challenging beauty standards.
 - **Joyful Noise:** For its celebration of gospel music, Black church culture, and community-driven narrative.
 - **Waiting to Exhale:** For its focus on sisterhood, romance, and navigating life's challenges as Black women.
- **Series:**
 - **Queen Sugar (OWN/Hulu):** Rich Southern setting, complex family drama, and empowered Black female leads.
 - **P-Valley (Starz):** Authentic portrayal of specific Southern communities, strong female characters, and vibrant cultural atmosphere.
 - **Good Times/The Jeffersons (Classic Sitcoms):** For their blend of humor, social commentary, and family resilience within the Black community.

PRODUCTION VALUE

MISS JUNETEENTH BLUES demands a vibrant, cinematic aesthetic that captures the lush, humid beauty of Baton Rouge, Louisiana. We envision a **high production value** that is visually engaging and emotionally immersive.

- **Visuals:** Rich color palettes, dynamic cinematography, and evocative lighting will highlight the contrasts between the faded glory of Toni's salon and the glittering, yet ultimately false, world of the pageant. Gospel montages will be visually stunning, blending reality with a touch of Southern surrealism.
- **Music:** A powerful, soulful soundtrack incorporating gospel, jazz, and contemporary Southern sounds will be integral to the storytelling and emotional impact.
- **Authenticity:** Meticulous attention to detail in set design, costumes, and local atmosphere will ensure an authentic portrayal of Southern Black culture, from church pews to bustling beauty salons.
- **Performances:** The material will attract top-tier talent, ensuring powerful and nuanced performances that bring these compelling characters to life.

We aim for a polished, premium feel suitable for both network broadcast and competitive streaming platforms, ensuring that every frame resonates with the story's heart and soul.

STORY & HOOK – WHY THIS STORY MATTERS NOW

In an era where authenticity and breaking down traditional barriers are paramount, **MISS JUNETEENTH BLUES** couldn't be more timely. This story resonates deeply because it:

- **Reimagines Tradition:** Juneteenth, now a federal holiday, is gaining increasing national prominence. This film respectfully celebrates the holiday while challenging the dated, sometimes superficial, aspects of its associated traditions, creating a conversation around what true legacy means.
- **Empowers Authenticity:** At a time when social media often dictates unrealistic beauty standards, Toni's journey—culminating in the viral wig moment—is a powerful statement about embracing one's true self, flaws and all. It's a rallying cry for "Crowns Over Perfection."
- **Champions the Undervalued:** It highlights the strength and wisdom of older women, often overlooked in media, proving that second chances and reinvention are possible at any age.

- **Sparks Intergenerational Dialogue:** The dynamic between Toni and Amara offers a relevant look at how mothers and daughters navigate evolving dreams, expectations, and the path to mutual respect.
- **Exposes Systemic Issues:** The corruption within the pageant subtly reflects larger societal issues of privilege and gatekeeping, offering a satisfying narrative of justice and community-led reform.

This story offers not just entertainment, but a mirror and a blueprint for empowerment, making it a compelling, conversation-starting project for today's audience.

DEMOGRAPHICS

- **Primary:** Black women, ages 25-65+
 - **Secondary:** All women, ages 25-65+; Millennials and Gen Z (18-34) interested in social relevance and empowerment themes; Families.
 - **Geographic Appeal:** Strong in the Southern US, but universal themes ensure national and international appeal.
 - **Interests:** Family dramas, romantic comedies, inspirational stories, cultural celebrations, female empowerment, justice narratives, authentic representation.
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MARKETABILITY

MISS JUNETEENTH BLUES is exceptionally marketable, boasting multiple compelling angles:

- **Star Power:** The project is designed to attract a phenomenal ensemble cast, guaranteeing built-in audience appeal and robust promotional opportunities.
- **Timely Hook:** The Juneteenth theme provides a culturally relevant peg, allowing for seasonal programming and strong tie-ins to national conversations.
- **Social Media Ready:** The "wig flying off" moment is an organic, viral marketing opportunity, ripe for memes, GIFs, and trend-setting hashtags like #CrownsOverPerfection.
- **Universal Themes:** While culturally specific, the themes of second chances, mother-daughter love, and finding authenticity are universally relatable, ensuring broad audience reach.
- **Strong Narrative Arcs:** Each character has a clear and satisfying journey, promising emotional investment from viewers.
- **Uplifting Message:** The story leaves audiences feeling inspired, hopeful, and entertained, a sought-after quality in today's content landscape.

- **Multi-Platform Potential:** Equally suited for linear broadcast, where it can drive significant live viewership, and for streaming platforms, where it offers strong bingeability and subscriber appeal.

This project delivers on all fronts: heart, humor, drama, social relevance, and undeniable market appeal.